Lab 6: Same reviewers, same findings, and the PR comment loses them all

Topic 1: Agentic Architecture & Orchestration · Task 1.3: Configure subagent invocation, context passing, and spawning

Runs on Simulator 5: Claude Code for Continuous Integration · Run in class

Source: SkillCertPro practice exam Part 1, Q2 (unofficial third-party question)

Commit to an answer first

The coordinator delegates pull request review work to separate subagents for security, test coverage, and maintainability. Each subagent returns useful findings to the coordinator, but the final review summary often omits specific file paths, failing test names, and evidence snippets that the coordinator already received. What change best addresses this reliability issue?

A. Tell the review synthesis subagent to infer missing details from the coordinator's earlier conversation history.

B. Run the synthesis subagent before the specialized review subagents to reduce context size.

C. Pass each prior subagent's complete structured findings directly into the review synthesis subagent's prompt.

D. Store the security and test coverage instructions in CLAUDE.md for the next CI pipeline run.

Simulate the solution

```
# In the browser: open Simulator 5, then Lab 6
cd labs
uv run serve.py

# In Claude Code, from the labs folder
/lab 6

# In a terminal, from simulators/simulator-5-ci-cd/
uv run ci_subagents.py --compare
```

What you should see

File paths and failing test names survive with --pass-findings and vanish with --lossy.

ci_subagents.py --pass-findings keeps the file paths, line numbers and test names in the final PR comment; --lossy drops most of them. The evaluate step prints the preservation percentages.

Open `simulators/simulator-5-ci-cd/evidence/` and find it yourself.

The answer

C. Paste each reviewer's complete JSON findings into the synthesis prompt.

The coordinator is responsible for moving information between workers. Subagents run in fresh, isolated conversations: they do not receive the parent's history or earlier tool results. The reliable pattern is to pass prior outputs as structured context in the Agent tool prompt, for example findings grouped by file, severity, evidence excerpt, command output and recommended fix. The synthesis subagent's own system prompt, tools or CLAUDE.md memory do not replace the run-specific findings it has to synthesise.

Why the others fail

A. The synthesis subagent cannot see the coordinator's history. Asking it to “infer” details invites invented paths and test names; the video calls this an orchestration anti-pattern.

B. Running synthesis first reverses the dependency: there is nothing to synthesise yet.

D. CLAUDE.md holds stable project guidance. It cannot carry this pull request's findings into the handoff.

Check yourself

- pass-findings mode preserves at least 80% of the file paths the reviewers reported
- lossy mode preserves fewer paths and test names than pass-findings mode
- the coordinator spawned the three reviewers in one response (parallel Agent calls)

Now change one thing

Fix the loop in repo/stock/totals.py and the caller in repo/stock/jobs.py, rerun, and watch the blocking count fall.

Third-party practice material from SkillCertPro, reconstructed from a video transcript in the Tertiary Markdown Vault. Not a real exam item. Wording may differ from the original.